Nova AI -- Interview Scoring Rubrics

Scoring Scale (1-10)

All competencies are scored on a 1-10 scale. Scores are normalized across interviewers using an automated calibration model.

- 1-3: Below expectations -- significant gaps in knowledge or skill
- 4-5: Developing -- meets some expectations with notable gaps
- 6-7: Proficient -- solid foundation, meets role requirements
- 8-9: Advanced -- deep expertise, exceeds expectations
- 10: Exceptional -- world-class, rare depth and breadth

Competency: Problem Solving (Weight: 25%)

Evaluates structured thinking, decomposition of complex problems, and ability to reason through ambiguity.

- Clarity of approach -- How well does the candidate structure their solution?
- Edge case handling -- Do they naturally consider boundary conditions?
- Trade-off awareness -- Do they discuss time/space complexity or design trade-offs?
- Iteration speed -- How quickly do they refine their initial approach?

Competency: Technical Knowledge (Weight: 25%)

Depth and breadth of domain-specific knowledge relevant to the role.

- Core CS fundamentals (data structures, algorithms, design patterns)
- Language/framework proficiency relevant to the role
- System design concepts (scalability, reliability, latency)
- Ability to discuss recent industry trends and technologies

Competency: Communication (Weight: 15%)

Clarity of explanation, active listening, and ability to articulate technical concepts.

- Explains thought process clearly without prompting
- Asks clarifying questions before diving into solutions
- Adapts communication style to the audience
- Provides constructive feedback in peer discussions

Competency: System Design (Weight: 20%)

Only assessed for senior roles (IC4+). Evaluates architectural thinking.

- Requirements gathering -- identifying functional and non-functional requirements
- High-level architecture -- components, data flow, APIs
- Trade-off analysis -- justifying design decisions with alternatives
- Scalability considerations -- load balancing, caching, sharding, replication

Competency: Coding (Weight: 10%)

Quality and correctness of code written during the interview.

- Correctness -- solution passes provided test cases
- Code quality -- readability, naming, modularity
- Language idioms -- uses language features appropriately

- Testing mindset -- writes or suggests test cases naturally

Competency: Culture Fit (Weight: 5%)

Alignment with Nova AI values and team dynamics.

- Collaboration -- examples of working effectively in teams
- Growth mindset -- openness to feedback and continuous learning
- Inclusivity -- awareness and respect for diverse perspectives